Fair Speaking Rubric

Any speaking task | Four criteria | 0-4 plus N/A

Student: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Task / goal: _____

Allowed support: _____

Assess the stated task using the language taught. A short, clear response can earn full credit. Examples and target phrases are support, not a compulsory script.

Criterion	4 Fully achieved	3 Mostly achieved	2 Partly achieved	1 Limited	0 Not achieved
Task Achievement	Achieves all material goals with accurate, relevant information and an appropriate outcome.	Achieves the main outcome; a small omission does not prevent success.	Achieves part of the task, but misses or confuses an important requirement.	Makes limited relevant progress; most important requirements remain unmet.	An observable attempt does not achieve a task-relevant outcome.
Interaction	Responds appropriately and uses relevant questions, clarification or confirmation when needed; closes naturally.	Maintains a mostly appropriate exchange; resolves an occasional misunderstanding.	Participates partly, but several relevant questions or responses remain unresolved.	Sustains little relevant exchange despite genuine opportunities to respond.	An observable attempt gives no relevant response despite a clear interaction opportunity.
Language Range & Control	Uses enough appropriate, familiar language to express the intended meaning; minor errors do not obstruct it.	Uses suitable words and sentence patterns; some errors cause occasional ambiguity.	Limited vocabulary or control repeatedly makes important meanings ambiguous.	Mostly isolated words or unclear sentence patterns convey little intended meaning.	An observable language attempt conveys no usable task-relevant meaning.
Communication & Fluency	Expresses a clear, sufficiently connected message that the listener can follow for this task.	Communicates the main message clearly, with occasional missing links or unclear references.	Conveys some of the message, but key parts require interpretation or clarification.	Conveys little of the message clearly, even after a reasonable clarification opportunity.	An observable attempt leaves the task-relevant message unintelligible.

N/A is not zero

Use N/A when usable evidence or a relevant opportunity is missing. Use 0 only for an observed unsuccessful attempt. A presentation with no interaction opportunity has N/A for Interaction.

Keep criteria separate: do not automatically deduct an understandable grammar error from task success. Allowed maps, phrases, replay or Help do not prevent a 4.

Teacher scoring record

Score only the enabled, relevant criteria. Record evidence before giving a total.

Criterion	Score / N/A	Quotation or observable evidence
Task Achievement		
Interaction		
Language Range & Control		
Communication & Fluency		

Total: _____ / _____ Criteria assessed: _____ / 4

Maximum = 4 x the number of assessed criteria (normally 16). Report which criteria are N/A. Do not treat totals with different evidence or support conditions as equivalent.

Fair scoring checks

1. Judge the stated task and the opportunities actually provided. Do not add hidden requirements from textbook examples, suggested steps or vocabulary lists.

2. Natural equivalents and simple taught language can earn 4. Do not require every target phrase, advanced grammar, long answers or memorized dialogue.

3. Allowed maps, expressions, example dialogues, transcript, replay and Help are task conditions. Their use alone cannot lower a score or prevent 4.

4. A useful clarification or self-correction can show successful interaction. Do not deduct merely because the learner requests repetition or checks a detail.

5. Separate the criteria: minor grammar errors belong in language control only when they affect it; do not automatically deduct the same error from achievement or clarity when communication succeeds.

6. Use null (N/A), not 0, when usable evidence or a genuine opportunity is missing. Mark an unobserved goal requirement uncertain; do not blame the learner for AI scaffolding, early closure or technical failures.

7. Use 0 only for an observable unsuccessful attempt. Blank recordings, microphone failures and missing transcripts are insufficient evidence, not demonstrated failure.

8. Do not infer pronunciation, accent quality, speech speed, pauses, eye contact, confidence, motivation or attitude from transcript text, recording duration or response latency.

9. Use criterion-specific transcript evidence and consider speech-recognition uncertainty. Do not reward invented facts; a legitimate offer to check an unknown fact can be successful.

10. Score only enabled, relevant criteria. For a presentation with no interaction opportunity, Interaction is N/A; it is not an automatic zero. Keep assessment conditions consistent across learners.

One strength: _____

Next step: _____

Calibrate with sample performances before testing. Use multiple observations and teacher judgment for consequential school reporting. This local task rubric does not assign official school grades or CEFR levels.

Design references

NIER: Junior-high foreign-language assessment guidance | Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors